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IT Equipment Hardening Policy

Document Control chart.

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Document Revision chart.

Date	Version	Reviewed by	Changes
Sept 2024	1.0	Director - IT, InfoSec & Product Development	No changes
Sept 2025	1.0	Director - IT, InfoSec & Product Development	No changes

Data Privacy Policy

1. Purpose

The purpose of this document is to outline the baseline hardening procedures for IT equipment used within the organization to mitigate security risks and ensure compliance with industry standards.

2. Scope

This document applies to all IT equipment including but not limited to:

- Servers (physical and virtual)
- Desktops and laptops
- Network devices (routers, switches, firewalls)
- Mobile devices
- Storage devices
- Printers and IoT devices

3. General Hardening Principles

- **Least Privilege:** Users and services should run with the minimum level of access necessary.
- **Patch Management:** Regular updates and patches must be applied to all systems.
- **Disable Unused Services:** Turn off all unnecessary services, ports, and features.
- **Change Default Credentials:** Default usernames and passwords must be changed upon setup.
- **Logging and Monitoring:** Enable logging and implement a centralized monitoring system.

4. Hardening Procedures by Equipment Type

4.1 Servers

- Install only required roles and features.
- Disable unused ports and services.
- Implement anti-malware and endpoint detection.
- Configure host-based firewalls.
- Apply OS hardening scripts or tools (e.g., CIS Benchmarks).
- Enforce secure SSH/RDP configurations.

4.2 Workstations (Laptops/Desktops)

- Apply full disk encryption (e.g., BitLocker).
- Enforce strong password policies.
- Disable USB access where not needed.
- Install antivirus/endpoint protection software.
- Restrict local admin access.
- Ensure auto-lock screensaver policies are active.

4.3 Network Equipment

- Change default SNMP strings and credentials.
- Disable unused interfaces.
- Implement port security and MAC address filtering.
- Use secure management protocols (e.g., SSH, HTTPS).

- Backup configurations regularly.
- Apply firmware updates.

4.4 Mobile Devices

- Enable device encryption and remote wipe capabilities.
- Require PIN or biometric authentication.
- Disable unnecessary apps and services.
- Use containerization for corporate data.

4.5 Printers and IoT Devices

- Change default admin credentials.
- Disable unused protocols (FTP, Telnet, etc.).
- Segment these devices on isolated VLANs.
- Regularly update firmware.
- Enable logging where available.

5. Compliance and Auditing

- Regular vulnerability assessments and penetration tests must be conducted.
- Maintain audit logs of configuration changes.
- Review hardening compliance quarterly.
- Use automated tools (e.g., Nessus, OpenVAS, SCCM, etc.) for audits.

6. Exceptions

Any deviations from these hardening guidelines must be documented and approved by the IT Security Team.

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